

Get the Response of a GET API Request

Sending a GET request and verifying the response in Postman

Hands-On	5
Scenario	Get the response of GET API Request
Tool	Postman (Desktop or Web)
Method	GET
Endpoint URL	https://restful-booker.herokuapp.com/auth
Duration	20 minutes
Prerequisite	Workspace and Collection already created

Objective

The objective of this assignment is to send a **GET** request from Postman to the Restful Booker **/auth** endpoint and inspect the response that the server returns. The focus of this exercise is on navigating to the right workspace and collection, configuring the request, sending it, and reading the various pieces of information available in the response panel — status code, response time, size, headers and body.

Important Note

The Restful Booker /auth endpoint is officially a POST endpoint used for token generation. Sending a **GET** request to this URL will not return a token — the server will respond with a **404 Not Found** (or similar error status). This is expected behaviour and the assignment uses it to demonstrate how Postman displays both successful and failed responses, and how to read the response panel for any HTTP request.

Steps to Send and Verify the GET Request

1 Go to the Right Workspace

Open Postman (desktop or web) and sign in if not already logged in.

Click the **Workspaces** dropdown in the upper-left corner.

Select the workspace created in the earlier assignment (for example, *Bitcoin API Tests*).

2 Go to the Right Collection

In the left sidebar, click the **Collections** tab.

Locate and click the collection created earlier (for example, *Bitcoin Rate API Tests*).

The collection expands to display its existing requests (if any).

3 Add a New Request

Click the **Add a request** link inside the collection, or click the three-dot (...) menu next to the collection name and choose **Add request**.

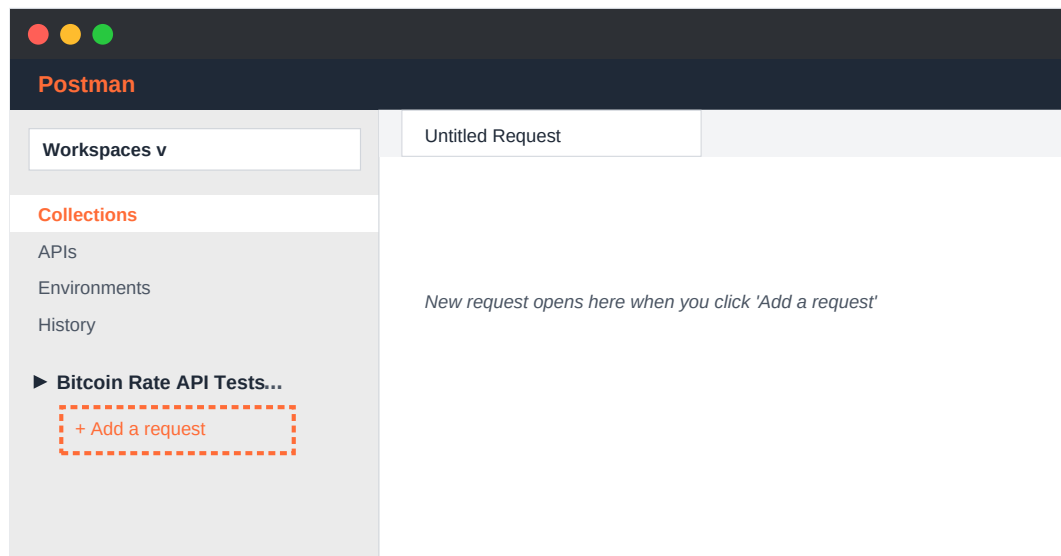


Figure 1 — Left sidebar showing the Workspaces dropdown, the active collection, and the highlighted + **Add a request** link.

4 New Tab Opens with the Empty Request

Postman opens a new request tab in the central panel.

By default it is named *Untitled Request*, with the HTTP method set to **GET** and an empty URL field.

5 Give the Request a Meaningful Name

Click on *Untitled Request* at the top of the tab (or right-click the request in the sidebar and choose **Rename**).

Enter a clear, descriptive name such as *Auth Status Test* or *GET Restful Booker Auth*.

Press **Enter** or save with **Ctrl + S** / **Cmd + S** to apply the new name.

6 Set the HTTP Method to GET

Click the **method dropdown** (left of the URL field).

Select **GET** from the list. **GET** is used to retrieve data from the server without modifying any resource.

7 Enter the Request URL

Click into the URL field and type or paste:

`https://restful-booker.herokuapp.com/auth`

No headers, params or body are required for this exercise.

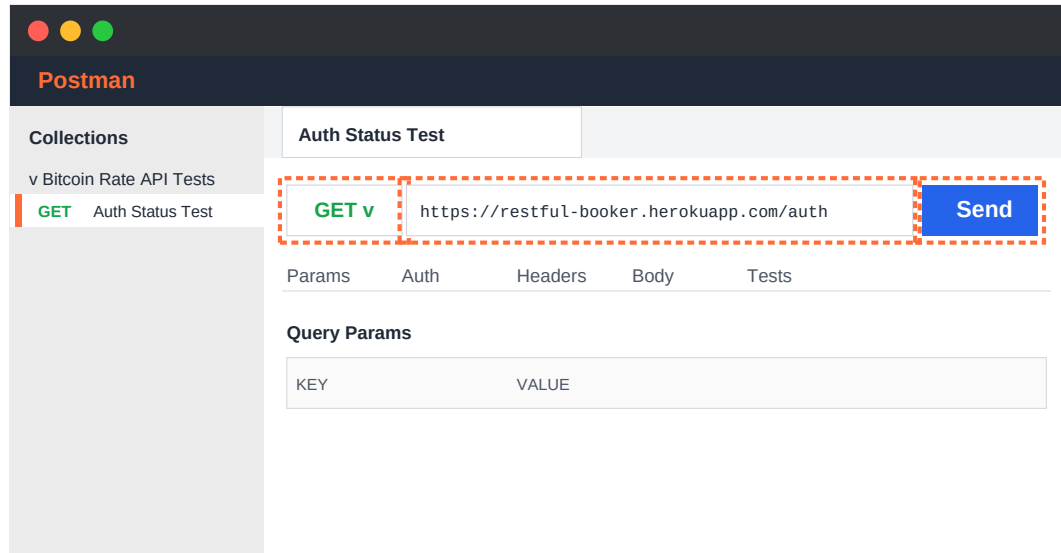


Figure 2 — Request configured: method set to **GET**, URL entered, and the **Send** button highlighted on the right.

8 Click the “Send” Button and Verify the Response

Click the blue **Send** button on the right side of the URL bar.

Postman dispatches the request and displays the server's response in the lower **Response** panel.

Inspect the following elements of the response:

- **Status** — for a GET on this URL the server returns **404 Not Found** because /auth only accepts POST.
- **Time** — how long the request took to complete (e.g. ~300 ms).
- **Size** — the size of the response payload in bytes.
- **Body tab** — shows the response body content.
- **Headers tab** — lists all response headers returned by the server.
- **Cookies tab** — shows any cookies set by the server.

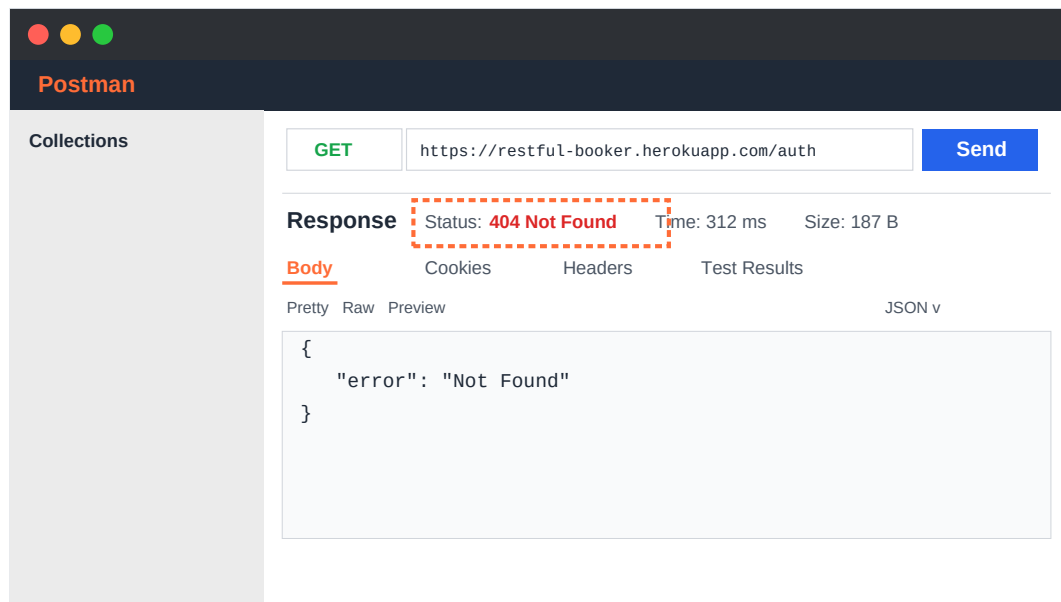


Figure 3 — Response panel showing status, time and size, with the **Body** tab active and a JSON error response.

Expected Response

Because **/auth** is a POST-only endpoint, sending a GET to it returns a 404 error status code. Postman highlights this in red in the status indicator. A typical response body looks like:

```
{
  "error": "Not Found"
}
```

To get a successful 200 OK response with an authentication token, the same URL must be called using the **POST** method along with a JSON body containing valid **username** and **password** fields. This will be covered in upcoming assignments.

Verification Checklist

- 1 The response panel appears immediately after clicking **Send**.
- 2 A status code is displayed (**404 Not Found** in this case).
- 3 The response time and size are displayed alongside the status.
- 4 The **Body** tab shows the response payload returned by the server.
- 5 The **Headers** tab lists all response headers.
- 6 The request is saved (**Ctrl + S / Cmd + S**) inside the chosen collection in the left sidebar.

Conclusion

A GET request was successfully created, sent, and its response inspected in Postman. Even when the server returns an error status, Postman presents all the relevant response information — status code, headers, body, time and size — in a clear, structured way. Reading these details accurately is a fundamental skill for the test scripts and assertions that will be added in upcoming assignments.